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E. O. 11652, Sec. 3(E) and 5(D) or (E)
Dept. of State letter, Aug. 9, 1973
By NLT-[illegible], NARS Date 2-20-76

EXTRACT

MEMORANDUM FOR THE CHIEF OF STAFF:
31 December 1943,
Subject: Equipping Chinese Divisions.
(Files of the Department of the Army, OPD 400.3295 China (15 Dec 43))

1. General Ferris' attached message[1] withholds comment requested by the War Department on a proposed supply policy regarding the Lend-Lease equipping of Chinese Divisions. General Ferris' action is based on his understanding of a Presidential commitment made at Sextant.

2. Our message which outlined the proposed supply policy is also attached.[1] The policy set forth makes the provision in the 1944 Army Supply Program for the full requirements of the 1st Thirty Divisions and for 10% of the requirements for the 2nd Thirty Divisions. It also contained provisions designed to regulate the flow of material from the United States to India and the size of stock piles in India commensurate with theater ability to transport the material into China.

. . .

4. As to the timing of the flow of Lend-Lease equipment to China, the President indicated (Tab A)[1] in his message of 27th December to the Generalissimo that the rate of movement of material into China depends largely upon the employment to be made of the Yunnan Divisions in the near future.

5. The commitment regarding the Lend-Lease equipping of Chinese Divisions the President actually made at Sextant is not known. We are proceeding on the assumption that the President made no commitment on the timing of the flow of equipment.

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[1]Not reproduced.

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6. It is recommended that you approve the following reply to General Stilwell:

"Commitment by the President did not make any reference to the timing of the flow of equipment from the U.S. to the Theater but did make it clear that the U.S. intends eventually to provide equipment for the entire Chinese Army. . . . The completion of equipment will undoubtedly be impracticable until after the defeat of Germany. This is apparent when we consider that the Chinese Divisions in the three groups total ninety which is the size of the entire U.S. Army. . . ."

THOS T. HANDY,
Major General,
Assistant Chief of Staff

[NOTE: Original memo was approved and message sent as CM-OUT-11706 to Gen. Sultan with certain changes in wording.]